

Christopher Ortega

LLM Engineering • LLMOps • Data Platforms

Denver, CO • 303-667-3831 • denverchrisortega@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Results-driven LLM and data platform engineer with 6+ years building high-throughput systems. Specialized in evaluation, safety, and infrastructure. HackAPrompt 2025 Top-10. Delivered pipelines processing 10+ TB/day with Kubernetes-native deployments and evaluation frameworks that improved accuracy while enforcing strict latency and safety bounds.

EXPERIENCE

Independent LLM Safety Research

Dec 2023 – Present • Denver, CO

- Placed Top-10 (7th) in HackAPrompt 2025 by building reusable adversarial testing harnesses and mitigation strategies for LLM systems.
- Designed evaluation suites of 200+ prompts with groundedness, refusal, and unsafe-rate metrics. Achieved ~9pp accuracy gains and p95 latency $\leq 1.8s$ with near-zero unsafe probes.
- Built a constrained Patent Intelligence Agent using hybrid semantic + CPC/IPC filtering and citation-trail navigation with RBAC controls.
- Created modular local LLM orchestration with prompt-rewrite stages, LoRA support, and graph configs for reproducible offline A/B testing.

Senior Software Engineer / Platform Tech Lead — Charter Communications

Feb 2019 – Nov 2023 • Denver, CO

- Led backend architecture for subscriber segmentation and measurement serving millions of users; aligned product, SRE, and engineering on release readiness.
- Built Scala/Spark batch and streaming pipelines processing 10+ TB/day with Kafka, Kinesis, and Lambda for real-time activation.
- Established RBAC, JWT, and OpenAPI versioning patterns that stabilized partner integrations across org boundaries.
- Containerized services on Kubernetes with GitLab CI/CD gates, materially reducing deployment risk.

Software Engineer (Frontend / Platform) — Access Data Consulting (Contract @ Charter)

Sep 2017 – Feb 2019 • Denver, CO

- Led migration of legacy interfaces to React + TypeScript, establishing shared components adopted across tools.
- Delivered accessible real-time dashboards integrated with targeting APIs; partnered on staged rollouts.

SKILLS

LLM & Evaluation

Prompt engineering • RAG • Evaluation design & metrics • Safety guardrails • Local LLM orchestration (Ollama) • PyTorch • LangChain

Data Platforms

Python • Spark (batch + streaming) • Kafka • Kinesis • AWS EMR/Lambda • Elasticsearch

Infrastructure & DevOps

Kubernetes • Docker • Terraform • GitLab CI/CD (gated releases) • Release engineering • API governance (OpenAPI, JWT)

Practices

Technical requirements documents • BDD acceptance • Observability • Cross-team architecture alignment

EDUCATION

B.S., Computer Information Systems — Metropolitan State University of Denver, 2012–2016

A.S., Business Management — Front Range Community College, 2010–2012